

Question 7 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the role and responsibilities of an HRD professional in an organisation.

Introduction

An HRD professional is not a clerk who books a hall and orders tea for a training programme. He or she is a specialist who designs systems so that people develop, and a partner who helps managers develop their teams. As organisations moved from personnel administration to strategic HRD, this role became broader: diagnostician, designer, facilitator, change agent and evaluator.

Detailed points

- 1. Diagnosing development needs.** The professional studies performance data, climate surveys, strategy and skill inventories to find gaps at organisation, job and person levels. Without diagnosis, HRD becomes a catalogue of fashionable workshops. Responsibility includes telling management when the problem is not training (e.g., broken machines) so money is not wasted.
- 2. Designing the HRD system.** Role includes structuring performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling so they work as one system. Isolated tools fail. The professional writes policies, designs forms that actually help conversation, and sequences the annual HRD cycle.
- 3. Facilitating learning.** The HRD person may train, but more often enables learning: choosing methods, developing internal trainers, arranging mentoring, e-learning and on-the-job projects. Informal coaching by managers is also HRD; the professional must help managers become coaches.
- 4. Culture and climate builder.** Responsibility to promote openness, trust, collaboration — through OD exercises, communication forums, and by advising leaders on their own behaviour. If the CEO publicly humiliates staff, the HRD professional must have the courage to name the climate damage.
- 5. Advisor and change agent.** During technology change, merger, quality drive or restructuring, people feel fear and skill shock. The HRD professional prepares them, manages resistance, and redesigns roles. This is a consulting role, not an administrative one.
- 6. Developing line managers as developers.** Notes stress that HRD is every manager's job. The professional trains bosses in appraisal discussion, feedback and counselling, and holds them accountable for team development. If line managers refuse, HRD remains a peripheral cell.
- 7. Evaluation, audit and ethics.** The role includes checking whether mechanisms help or hinder development (HRD audit), measuring training at more than smile-sheet level, and protecting fairness and confidentiality in counselling. An unethical HRD professional who leaks appraisal gossip destroys climate.
- 8. Competencies required.** To do all this, the professional needs knowledge of learning theory, organisation behaviour, business basics, facilitation skill, and integrity. The role has shifted from 'training administrator' to 'human capital architect'.

Conclusion. List roles with a line of explanation: diagnostician, system designer, learning facilitator, climate builder, change agent, developer of managers, evaluator. End: the HRD professional succeeds when managers develop people daily, not when the training calendar looks full.